



Metalinks for Download Anyone?

Still stuck to http/ftp downloads or have you moved to torrents instead? What if I say you can have the best of both worlds?

Downloading large files from a server with http/ftp is becoming obsolete now. People are more inclined towards using torrent downloads because of the obvious advantages over server downloads such as speed limits, connection timeout errors, etc.

Torrents, however, are not so useful when downloading something new like, say, a new Linux distribution release. The seed:peer ratio is almost zero. The servers are overloaded. You neither get much speed from any particular server nor from torrents. How

many times have you wished that you could supply more than a single server to your download manager to increase the speed a bit? Maybe mix torrents with the server downloads for even higher speeds? This is where Metalink steps in. Anthony Bryan came up with Metalink 11 years ago, but it still has not received the limelight it deserves.

In the simplest words, a Metalink is an XML file. This file contains the links to the various mirrors that host the file under consideration. It might also contain the location of the torrent of that file and/or